



Magic and music

Music and magic are naturally complementary art forms, each inspiring the other. Historically, traditional folk music has been used in ritual and ceremonial magic, instilling the appropriate mind-set or mood in participants and creating an atmosphere for dancing and chanting.

The link remains strong to this day, as is reflected in the many allusions to magic in contemporary popular music. This association began playfully in the mid-20th century, with songs such as Frank Sinatra's *That Old Black Magic* (1942), which used magic as a metaphor for love. With the 1960s came a drug-induced world of mysticism and ecstasy that was evident in pop songs such as Jimi Hendrix's *Voodoo Chile* (1968). New Age spirituality emerged at the same time, creating its own genre of music with compilations to aid meditation, yoga, and relaxation.

The trend continued in the 1970s and '80s as many artists referred to magical influences in their music. David Bowie's *Quicksand* (1971) and Ozzy Osbourne's *Mr. Crowley* (1980) both allude to occultist Aleister Crowley (see pp.250–251). The band Siouxsie and the Banshees (left) used imagery of witchcraft, Voodoo, and the occult, inspiring women to join the 1980s Gothic rock movement. Occult influences persist into the 21st century: in 2016, US rapper Azealia Banks pronounced herself a practicing witch, and in 2017, Canadian artist ANIIML branded her music “witch-pop.”

“Music is probably
the only real magic ...”

TOM PETTY, *THE TELEGRAPH*, 2012